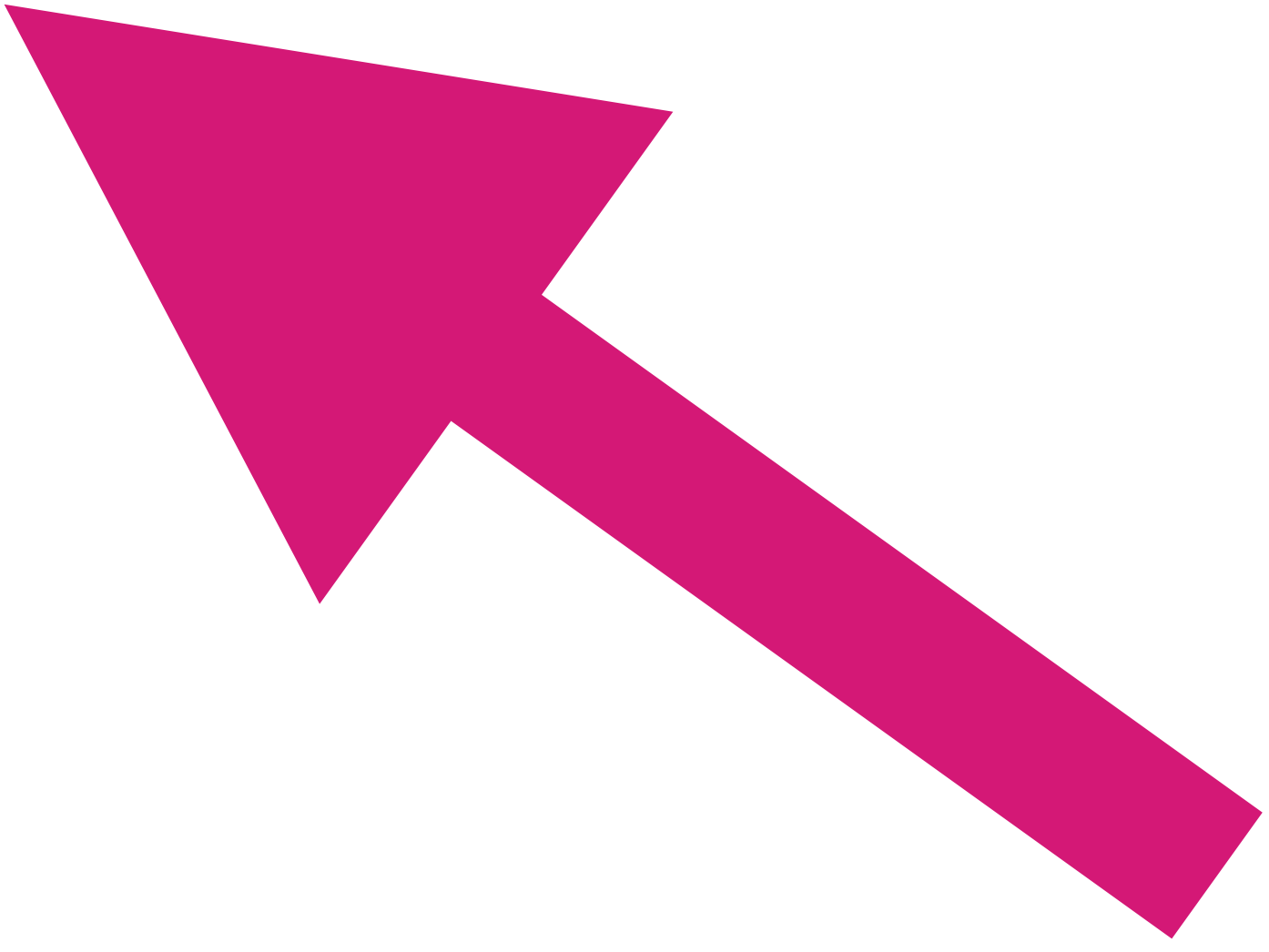
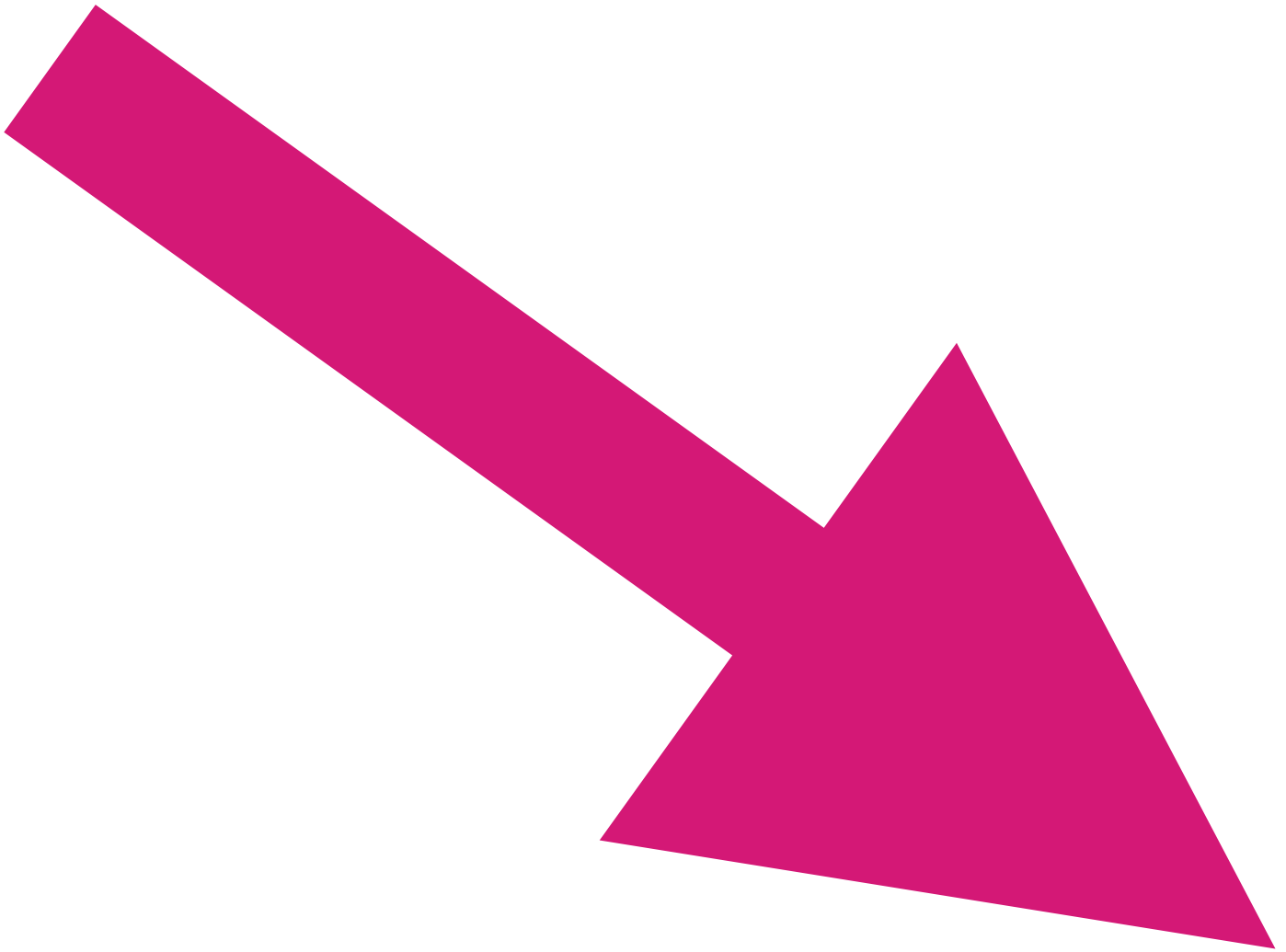
Gender categories

An analytical category is gendered (for critical feminist analytical purposes) if but not only if its members are socially positioned as subordinate or privileged along some dimension (economic, political, legal, social, etc.) due to (actually or potentially) observed or imagined bodily features presumed (taken, suspected, expected, etc.) to be evidence of a (present, previous, or future) body socially interpreted as sexed one way or another.

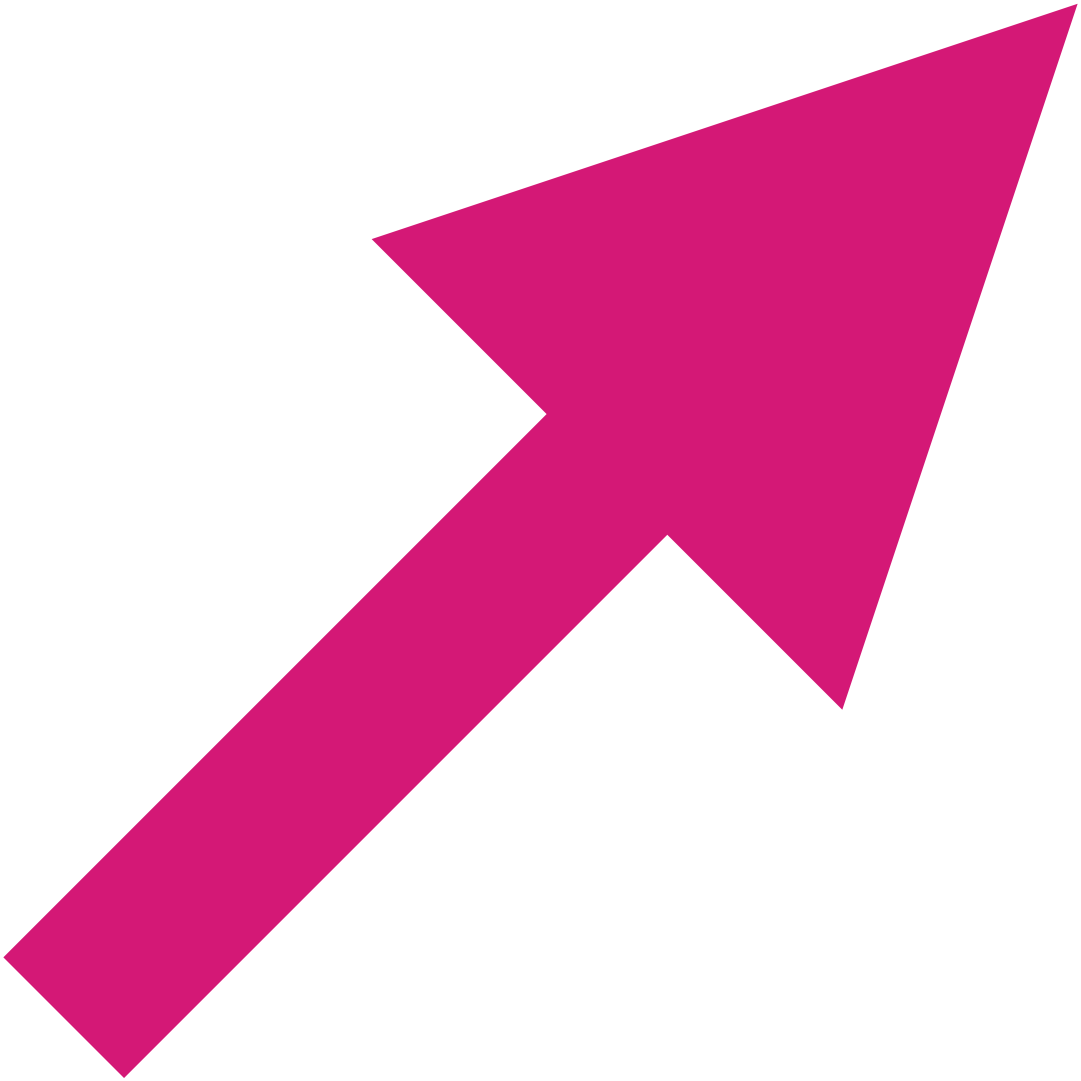
Sufficient condition



Not limited to “biological role in reproduction”



“Would be observed/ imagined” counts



Sufficient condition

An analytical category is gender (feminist analytical purposes) if but not only if its members are positioned as subordinate or privileged along some dimension (economic, political, legal, social, etc.) due to (actually or potentially) observed or imagined bodily features presumed (taken, suspected, expected, etc.) to be evidence of a (present, previous, or future) body socially interpreted as sexed one way or another.

"Would be observed/ imagined" counts

Gender categories

Not limited to "biological role in reproduction"

The gender categories useful for critical feminist analytical purposes need not be limited to, or even map onto, the genders familiar to us from the chair.

Nor must they anchor our authentic selves (gender categories vs. genders).